The `render` method is the heart of all rendering in Rails. It takes a hash of options that tell it what to render and how to render it.

It's tempting to write code in our controllers that looks like this:

```
# DO NOT DO THIS
def update
  @user = User.find(params[:id])
  if @user.update(user_params)
    render action: show
  end
  render template: "fix_user_errors"
end
```

It seems somehow natural that the act of calling `render` (and `redirect_to`) should somehow terminate the processing of an action. This isn't the case. The previous code will generate an error (because `render` is called twice) in the case where `update` succeeds.

Let's look at the render options used in the controller here (we'll look separately at rendering in the view starting in *Partial-Page Templates*):

render()

With no overriding parameter, the `render` method renders the default template for the current controller and action. The following code will render the template `app/views/blog/index.html.erb`:

```
class BlogController < ApplicationController
  def index
    render
  end
end
```

So will the following (as the default behavior of a controller is to call `render` if the action doesn't):

```
class BlogController < ApplicationController
  def index
```